



Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation
Nile Water Sector

Unlocking Finance for a Resilient WEFE (Water-Energy-Food-Ecosystems) Nexus in Egypt

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Navigating WEFE Nexus Funding Calls — Where to Find Them & How to Understand Them



Training professionals to design
bankable, resilient, and integrated
WEFE projects

Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation
Nile Water Sector

Purpose



This presentation aims to:



Strengthen ministry capacity in climate finance access



Translate WEFE Nexus into bankable investment pipelines

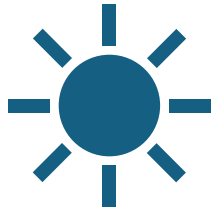


Improve proposal success rates with international donors



Align national strategies with global funding architectures

Why WEF Nexus Matters Now



Climate stress on water, food, and energy systems is accelerating



Donors now prioritize integrated solutions over sectoral projects



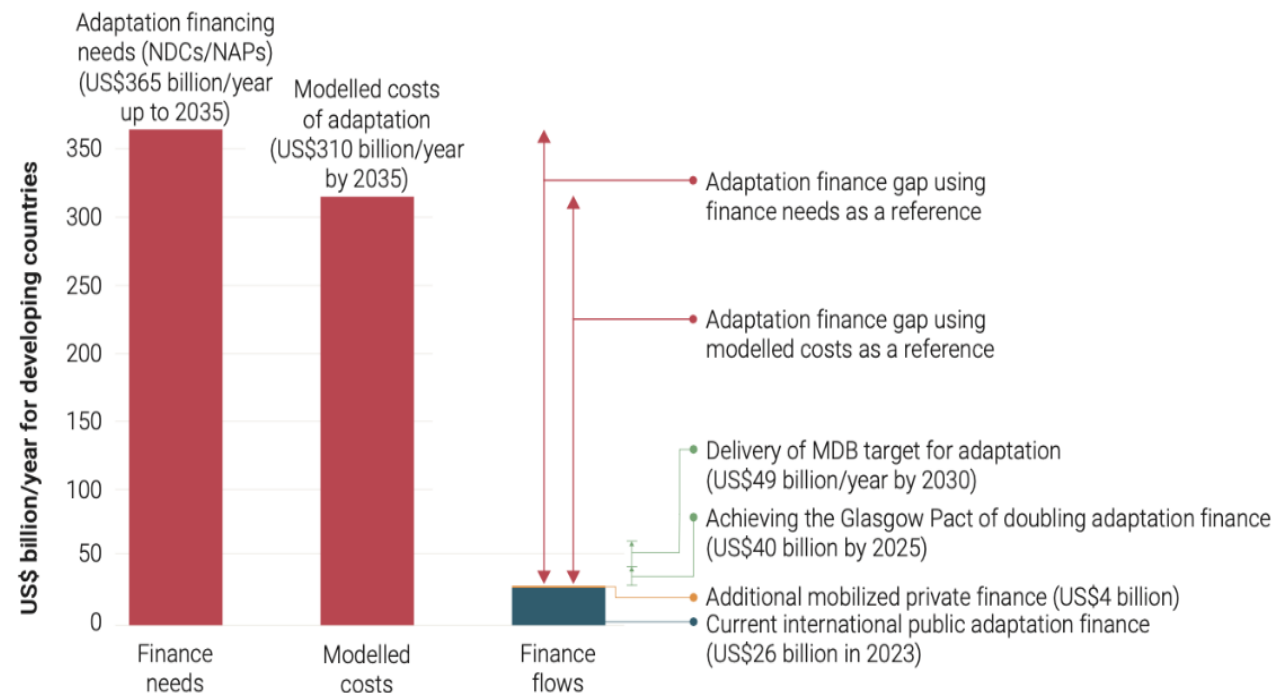
WEFE Nexus is becoming a **funding prerequisite**, not an option



Countries with integrated planning attract disproportionate funding

Global Funding Reality

- Climate finance exists at multi-billion scale annually
- The constraint is NOT funding availability
- The constraint is **project readiness and institutional capacity**
- Competition is between well-prepared national systems



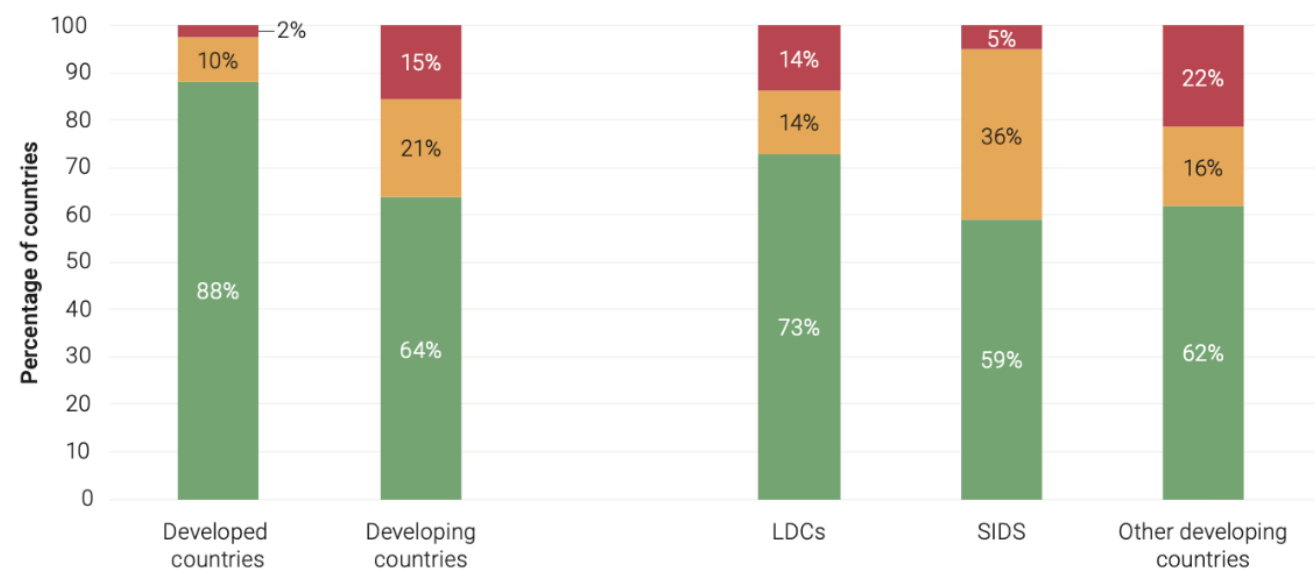
Note: In constant 2023 prices. Domestic and private finance flows are excluded.

Key Strategic Message

- **Funding does not follow ideas — it follows structured national systems**

Status of national adaptation planning instruments across different country classifications commonly used under the UNFCCC

- No national planning instrument in place
- National planning instrument is expired or over 10 years old
- National planning instrument is within its period of validity and under 10 years old



Global Climate Finance Architecture

Main financing channels:

- Multilateral Development Banks
- Climate Funds
- Bilateral Cooperation Agencies
- EU Programs
- Private Climate Finance Mechanisms

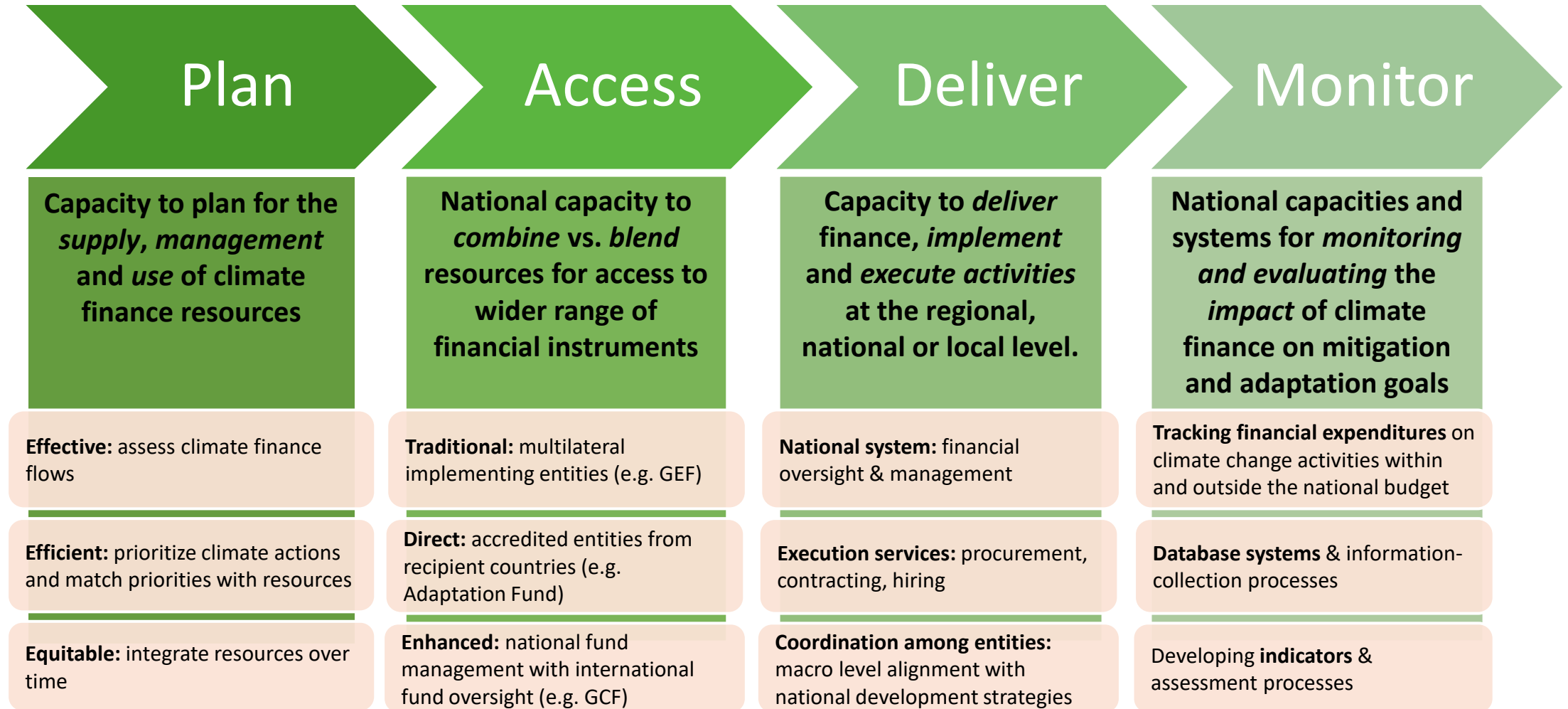
Key institutions:

- World Bank
- Green Climate Fund
- African Development Bank
- Islamic Development Bank

Types of Climate Finance

- Grants (technical assistance, studies)
- Concessional loans
- Blended finance instruments
- Equity investments
- Results-based financing
- Key Insight:
Different finance types require different proposal strategies

Climate Finance Readiness Process



Who is involved in Climate Finance?

Climate finance networks have been established to allow money to flow to adaptation and mitigation projects. There are several key players in Climate Finance

International Climate Funds

Governments can contribute money through funds including the Green Climate Fund (GCF), Global Environment Facility and Adaptation Fund.

Governments

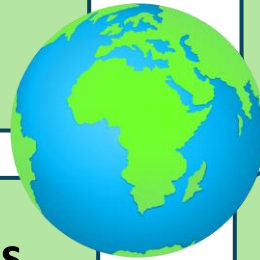
Governments can provide public money for climate finance. At COP15 in 2009 wealthy countries agreed to collectively provide \$100 billion a year in climate finance, however this target has not been met.

Multilateral Development Banks

These are international financial institutions consisting of member from multiple nations with the purpose of encouraging economic development in poorer nations. They provide loans and grants to countries for projects.

Private Sector

The Private Financial sector (Banks, Investors, Insurers) also mobilise money towards sustainable development. The United Nations Environment Programme Finance Initiative (UNEP FI) supports the private finance sector to do this.



WEFE Nexus Financing Domains

- Core investment areas:
- Water security systems
- Climate-smart agriculture
- Renewable energy integration
- Ecosystem restoration
- Digital transformation of resources
- Key Message:
WEFE Nexus is inherently cross-sectoral financ



Shift in Donor Priorities



DONORS NOW PRIORITIZE:



CLIMATE RESILIENCE
INSTEAD OF
INFRASTRUCTURE ALONE



SYSTEMS THINKING INSTEAD
OF ISOLATED PROJECTS



SCALABLE IMPACT INSTEAD
OF PILOT ACTIVITIES



GOVERNANCE AND
INSTITUTIONS INSTEAD OF
HARDWARE

Funding Lifecycle Overview

Standard donor process:

Idea → Concept Note →
Full Proposal → Technical
Review → Approval →
Implementation → Impact
Reporting

Key Insight:
**Most projects fail before
full proposal stage**

An abstract digital background featuring a grid of binary code (0s and 1s) in shades of blue and green. Overlaid on this are various mathematical formulas and symbols in a light blue, semi-transparent font. Visible formulas include $1+x+y+2a+21$, $\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} h$, $x=0 \times n$, $(1+x+y+2a+21) \times (g+x)$, $1-x+y+2a+21$, and $2+3y+2a$. There are also some geometric shapes like triangles and circles, and a vertical orange bar on the left side. The overall aesthetic is high-tech and mathematical.

Key instruments:

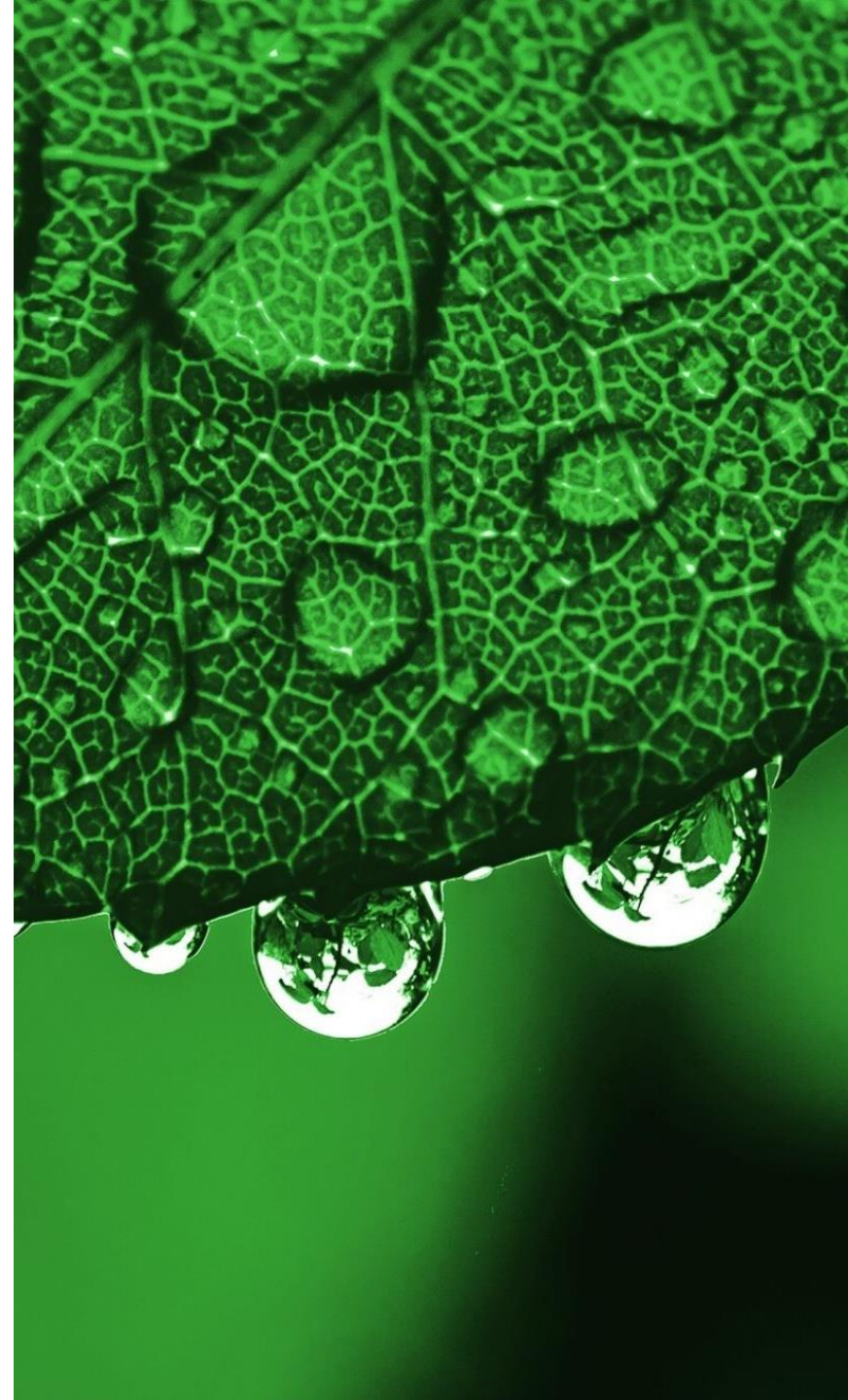
- Horizon Europe Cluster 6
- PRIMA Programme (Mediterranean focus)
- Global Gateway Investments

Focus areas:

- innovation
- climate adaptation
- regional cooperation
- digital transformation

Climate Funds Overview

- Major funds:
- Green Climate Fund
- Adaptation Fund
- Global Environment Facility
- Focus:
- large-scale adaptation
- transformational climate programs
- national implementation frameworks



**Core
Strategic
Insight**

**Every donor has a different
“approval logic” and success
depends on matching it.**



Shift Required in Ministries



Ministries must transition from:



Reactive funding search → proactive intelligence systems



Isolated projects → integrated national portfolios



Administrative roles → strategic funding actors



Key Message:

Institutional intelligence = funding success

What Makes a Bankable Project

A bankable WEFE project must include:

- Strong climate rationale
- Economic justification
- Institutional ownership
- Scalability design
- Social & gender inclusion
- Measurable impact framework



Donor Decision Logic

Donors evaluate:

- Climate impact potential
- Implementation capacity
- Financial sustainability
- Policy relevance
- Replication potential

Key Insight:

Technical quality alone is not sufficient



How Ministries Should Search Funding

Weekly monitoring sources:

- EU Funding & Tenders Portal
- PRIMA Foundation
- Green Climate Fund
- Adaptation Fund
- World Bank
- African Development Bank
- Islamic Development Bank

WEFE focus areas:

- water resilience
- food systems
- climate adaptation
- ecosystem restoration
- digital innovation

Funding Source Mapping (Strategic Overview)

Source	Size	Focus Area
Horizon Europe	€2–20M	Research & Innovation
PRIMA	€1–5M	Mediterranean WEFE
Green Climate Fund	\$20–300M	National climate programs
Adaptation Fund	\$5–25M	Pilot resilience projects
World Bank	\$50M–1B+	Infrastructure & reforms
African Development Bank	\$20–500M	Regional development
Islamic Development Bank	\$10–500M	Water & agriculture systems

What Evaluators Look For Before Approving Funding

Excellence

- Clear objectives
- Innovation
- Scientific and technical quality

Impact

- Climate adaptation benefits
- Economic and social benefits
- Policy influence
- Replication potential

Implementation

- Strong consortium
- Realistic work plan
- Qualified team
- Credible budget

What Evaluators Look For Before Approving Funding

- **Final Checklist**
 - ✓ Climate justification
 - ✓ Nexus integration
 - ✓ Gender inclusion
 - ✓ Stakeholder engagement
 - ✓ Financial sustainability
 - ✓ Monitoring and Evaluation Plan
- **Key Message:**

Most major donors evaluate proposals against three pillars: Excellence, Impact, and Quality of Implementation

Essential Funding Portals & Reference Sources

Objective: Identify the most important platforms for finding WEFE Nexus funding opportunities.

Organization	Website	Main Purpose
EU Funding & Tenders Portal	https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal	Horizon Europe, LIFE, Innovation Funding
PRIMA Foundation	https://prima-med.org	Mediterranean WEFE Nexus Calls
Green Climate Fund (GCF)	https://www.greenclimate.fund	Climate Adaptation & Mitigation Finance
Adaptation Fund	https://www.adaptation-fund.org	Adaptation Projects
World Bank Projects Portal	https://projects.worldbank.org	Active & Pipeline Projects
African Development Bank	https://www.afdb.org	Regional Infrastructure & Climate Finance
Islamic Development Bank	https://www.isdb.org	Water, Agriculture & Development Finance
NDC Partnership	https://ndcpartnership.org	Climate Finance Knowledge & Tools

How to Prepare a Winning WEFE Funding Proposal

- **Step 1 – Identify the Call**
- Read objectives carefully
- Study expected outcomes
- Review eligibility requirements
- **Step 2 – Build the Consortium**
- Government agencies
- Universities
- Private sector
- NGOs
- International partners
- **Step 3 – Develop the Concept**
- Climate problem
- Nexus solution
- Innovation
- Impact pathway



How to Prepare a Winning WEFE Funding Proposal

Build

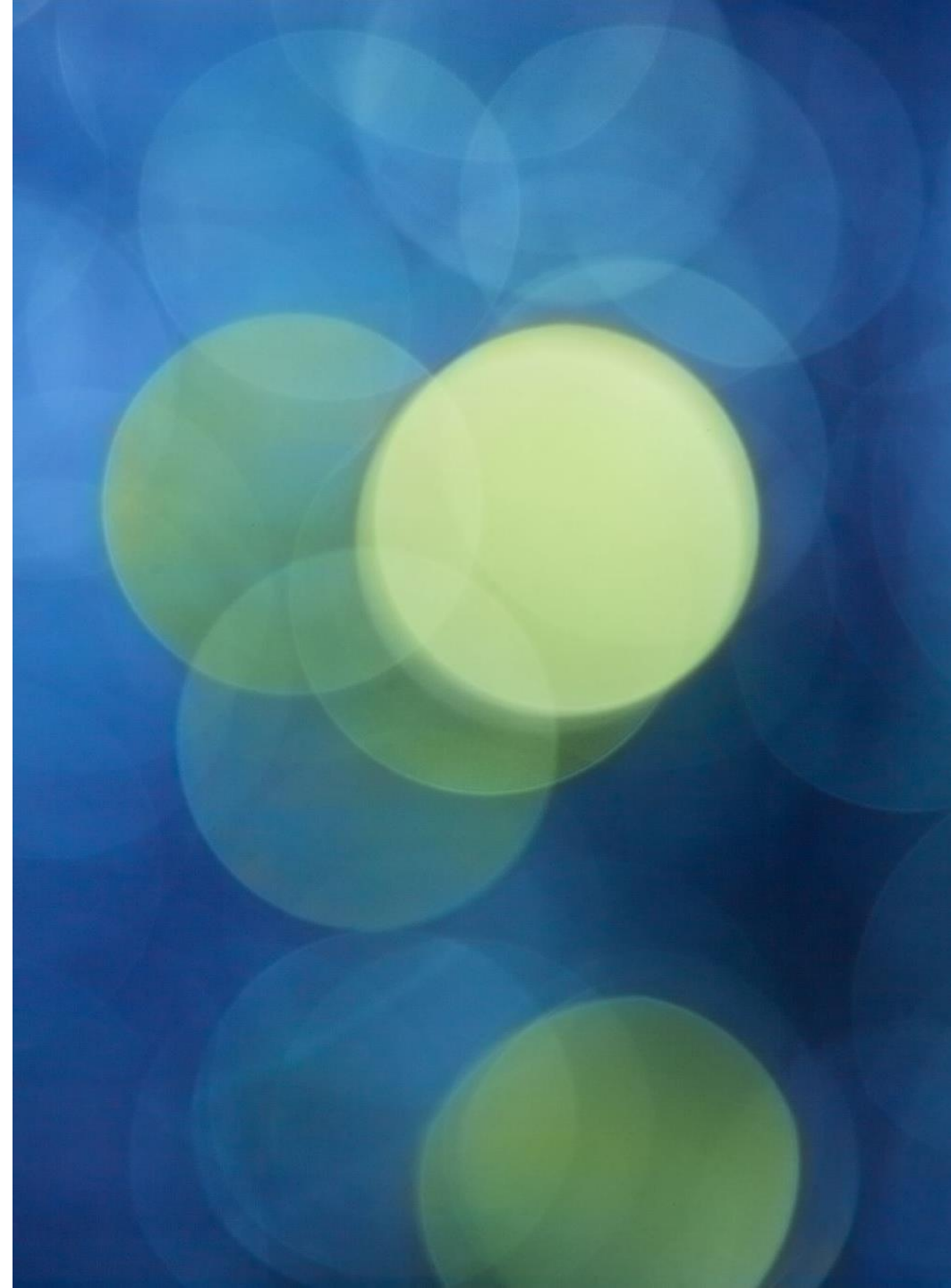
Build the Business Case

- Cost-benefit analysis
- Economic returns
- Climate benefits
- Sustainability plan

Prepare

Prepare Submission

- Technical proposal
- Budget
- Work packages
- Risk assessment
- Monitoring framework
- Key Message:
Successful proposals start 6–12 months before the call deadline.



Best Sources of Successful Project Examples

- **Horizon Europe Project Database**
<https://cordis.europa.eu>
- Search Topics:
 - Water Security
 - Climate Adaptation
 - Nature-Based Solutions
 - Food Systems
 - Circular Economy
- **PRIMA Project Database**
<https://prima-med.org/projects>
- Search Topics:
 - WEF E Nexus
 - Sustainable Agriculture
 - Water Reuse
 - Climate Resilience

Best Sources of Successful Project Examples

- **Green Climate Fund Projects**
<https://www.greenclimate.fund/projects>
- Study:
- Concept Notes
- Funding Proposals
- Theory of Change
- Financial Structures
- **World Bank Projects**
<https://projects.worldbank.org>
- Review:
- Project Appraisal Documents
- Economic Analyses
- Results Frameworks
- Implementation Arrangements
- **Key Message:**
The fastest way to learn proposal writing is to study approved projects rather than guidance documents alone.

SLIDE 44: Case Study 1 – Jordan's Aqaba–Amman Water Desalination & Conveyance Project

- **Project Overview**
- One of the world's largest climate adaptation and water security investments.
- **Key Figures**
- Total investment: ~USD 6 billion
- Water production: 300 million m³/year
- Pipeline length: 438 km
- Solar power component: 281 MW
- Expected contribution: Up to 40% of Jordan's municipal water needs by 2030
- **Financing Structure**
- Government of Jordan
- Green Climate Fund (GCF)
- International Finance Corporation (IFC)
- European Investment Bank (EIB)
- Private sector investors
- Public-Private Partnership (PPP)



SLIDE 44: Case Study 1 – Jordan's Aqaba–Amman Water Desalination & Conveyance Project

- **Why It Won Funding**
 - ✓ National water security priority
 - ✓ Strong climate adaptation narrative
 - ✓ Integrated Water-Energy Nexus approach
 - ✓ Large-scale socio-economic benefits
 - ✓ Blended finance model
- **Lessons for Egypt**
 - Frame projects as national resilience investments
 - Combine infrastructure with renewable energy
 - Use blended finance rather than relying on grants alone
 - Prepare projects years before funding approval
- **References**
 - Green Climate Fund FP288
 - IFC Project 47924
 - AIIB Project Documentation
 - EIB Water Security Programme



Case Study 2 – Singapore NEWater Programme

- **Project Overview**
- Singapore transformed wastewater into a strategic water resource.
- **Key Figures**
- NEWater supplies up to **40% of Singapore's water demand**
- Target: **55% by 2060**
- Operational cost approximately **USD 0.08–0.15 per m³**
- Based on advanced membrane filtration and reverse osmosis
- **Strategic Components**
- Wastewater reuse
- Desalination
- Rainwater harvesting
- Demand management





Case Study 2 – Singapore NEWater Programme

- **Why It Succeeded**
 - ✓ Strong governance framework
 - ✓ Long-term national strategy
 - ✓ Continuous investment in innovation
 - ✓ Public awareness campaigns
 - ✓ Integration of technology and policy
- **Lessons for Egypt**
 - Water reuse is a strategic water source
 - Governance matters as much as technology
 - Digital water systems improve efficiency
 - Public acceptance must be built early
- **References**
 - Singapore PUB Water Strategy
 - NEWater Programme Studies
 - Water Cycle Journal

Case Study – Morocco's National Water Security & Desalination Programme



- **Background**
- Morocco has faced repeated droughts and declining reservoir storage, forcing a major transformation of its water sector.
- **Key Investments**
- 17 desalination plants currently operating
- 4 additional plants under construction
- 9 more planned by 2030
- Target production: **1.7 billion m³/year**
- Goal: **60% of drinking water supplied from desalination by 2030**
- **Financing Sources**
- Government of Morocco
- European Investment Bank
- Private sector PPPs
- International climate finance
- Renewable energy investments

Case Study – Morocco's National Water Security & Desalination Programme



- **WEFE Nexus Components**
- Desalination
- Renewable energy
- Agricultural water allocation
- Water transfer infrastructure
- **Lessons for Egypt**
- ✓ National strategy attracts long-term finance
- ✓ Renewable energy reduces desalination costs
- ✓ Water security can become an economic growth driver
- **References**
- Reuters (Morocco Water Strategy 2025)
- Morocco National Water Plan
- EIB Water Investments

What Makes Large WEF E Projects Fundable?

Common Success Factors from Jordan, Singapore and Global Examples

Factor

Climate Justification

National Ownership

Economic Analysis

WEFE Nexus Integration

Scalability

Partnerships

Monitoring Framework

Co-financing

Why Donors Fund It

Demonstrates adaptation impact

Government commitment reduces risk

Shows return on investment

Delivers multiple benefits

Enables national replication

Strengthens implementation capacity

Measures impact

Improves leverage of donor funds



Common Success Factors

Strategic

- National ownership
- Long-term vision
- Clear priorities

Technical

- Strong feasibility studies
- Climate risk assessments
- Economic justification

Financial

- Co-financing
- Blended finance
- Project preparation funding

Common Success Factors

Institutional

- Dedicated implementation units
- Monitoring systems
- Multi-stakeholder coordination

Final Message

- **The projects receiving billions in climate finance today were often prepared 3–10 years before approval.**
- Successful countries invest in project preparation, institutional capacity, and strategic pipelines long before funding calls are announced



Thank you